MG4DSCENG200: INDIAN WRITING IN ENGLISH

Model Question Paper

Time: 2 hours **Max. Marks: 70**

Part A

Choose the right answer from the options given below. Answer all the questions. One question carries 1 mark.

1. According to Gandhi's warning in 1909, what would be the worst effect of conflating 'modern' with 'English'? [CO1; U]
   a) Loss of traditional Indian values b) "English rule without the Englishman"
   c) Economic dependence on Britain d) Decline of Sanskrit education
2. Why does Ambedkar use the Roman plebeian story? [CO1; U]
   a) To show ancient democratic ideals b) To argue that partial reforms fail
   c) To praise Roman leadership d) To highlight economic inequality
3. Which figure of speech is used in the phrase "those pale hands at which all mortals cower"? [CO2; U]
   a) Simile b) Personification c) Alliteration d) Hyperbole
4. How do the children initially perceive Nani's hanging body? [CO2; U]
   a) As a horrifying tragedy b) As a religious ritual
   c) As a comic dance moved by the wind d) As a warning from adults
5. What do the blind recover in the final line of the poem? [CO2; U]
   a) Memory b) Peace c) Hope d) Sight
6. What does the mascara symbolize for the woman? [CO2; U]
   a) Her prosperity and wealth b) Her desire to become an actress
   c) Her sadness and her attempt to hide pain d) Her childhood memories
7. What idea about parenting does the story question? [CO3; U]
   a) Strict discipline is always right b) Too much freedom can harm a child
   c) Children learn best through games d) Teachers should avoid homework
8. What was Medemla's profession? [CO3; U]
   a) Teacher b) Nurse c) Farmer d) Shopkeeper
9. Balram's murder of Ashok can best be read as [CO3; U]
   a) a heroic act b) a political rebellion
   c) a morally complex escape from oppression d) an impulsive crime
10. What is Naina's attitude toward the assault? [CO4; U]
    a) Indifferent b) Concerned and wants to help the victim
    c) Curious but passive d) Supportive of the men's discussion

Part B

Answer any six of the following in 100 words. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. What does Chandran mean by English as a "linguistic broker"? What price do the bhāshas pay for this mediation? [CO1; U]
12. Explain why Indian nationalism is described as "the nationalism of an idea" rather than based on conventional markers. [CO1; U]
13. Examine the structure of the poem "Nani". [CO2; An]
14. How does A. K. Ramanujan portray death in the poem? [CO2; An]
15. How does Parthasarathy describe the evolution of modern Tamil poetry? [CO2; An]
16. Analyse whether the tutor's final lie to the parents in "Crime and Punishment" is justified. [CO3; An]
17. Analyse how the novel *The White Tiger* contrasts the "Darkness" and the "Light" to critique India's development. [CO3; An]
18. How do Mohan and Bhaskar discuss the assault, and what does their conversation reveal about societal attitudes toward crime? [CO4; An]
19. Explain the symbolism of the title *Lights Out* and how it reflects the central themes of the play. [CO4; An]

Part C

Answer any two of the following in 300 words. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. In what ways does the play critique societal indifference and moral apathy, and how are these themes linked to the experiences of women in patriarchal structures? [CO4; An]
21. Explain how Parthasarathy describes the influence of Indian tradition and culture on modern Indian poets. [CO2; U]
22. Examine how the secrecy around Medemla's past and Martha's birth challenges patriarchal values in Naga society, and evaluate how well the story shows the emotional damage caused by this silence. [CO3; An]
23. Why does Ambedkar say that removing untouchability requires ending the caste system itself? [CO1; U]